

paying jobs, and have an increased opportunity to study and work abroad, there's pretty much nothing else we see in our futures. Now we may not know much about most other fields, but after a decade of involvement in the Indian technology industry, the one thing we can say is that India's time has come to show the world what we can really do.

It's innovation and entrepreneurship that we're placing our bets on for the near future. We need a Google, Apple or Microsoft to originate in India. Even a Facebook would do.

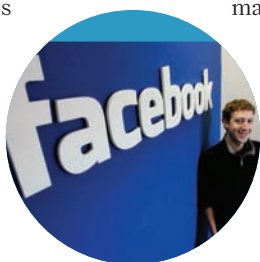
It's this thought that had us thinking for the past few months. "What's the next big idea that can create a Mark Zuckerberg?" we pondered. However, if you're expecting a nicely drawn up business plan, a non-patented idea and a clear-cut road map to becoming a billionaire all rolled into this article, you're in for a rather un-satisfying read. Seriously, if we knew what the big idea was, we'd be doing it ourselves, right?

"BAH! HUMBUG"

You're entitled to say that; but we did figure that, while we may not know what the next big idea is, just yet. We can still help you get started. We're hoping that we can help in some small way, and that you'll remember us if you ever become a billionaire – we'll accept cash, cheque, and even PayPal!

OK. Seriously now. We figured there have to be at least a few thousand potential billionaires amongst the lakhs of you reading this

magazine. You just don't know it yet. All you really need is the right idea, a platform to launch yourself, and a deeper understanding of what's needed. Easier said than done, we know, but we figured why not give it a shot?



ON YOUR MARK

Before you get started on your road to success, it's important to understand a few things. For one, we sincerely

believe that the Next Best Thing™ will be something made by Indians, for Indians. The trend these days is to only bother about the global market, promptly ignoring our own huge market.



SCROOGE MCDUCK

The perception that we Indians have of ourselves is that we're cheapskates looking for a free ride and bargains, and not really interested in paying for quality. We disagree. For one, we wouldn't exist ourselves if

Indians were cheap. Look at the mobile penetration we have – over 600 million. It's consistent through all sections of society, and is considered a necessity. While we may not believe in splurging on luxuries, we will spend any amount on things that we feel are useful or necessary. It's why brands like Karbonn and Micromax have grown so much in the past few years.

What would have happened if, instead of focussing on first grabbing market share in the value segment, these brands



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